

# **GEM Cluster Timing**

Dean Reiter

Darklight Software Meeting

June 22, 2026

When there is a particle track, when do we detect the clusters in each GEM?

(relative to the trigger time)

- How do we define the time of a cluster?
- Can we distinguish “good” clusters from “junk” clusters based on their timing relative to scintillator hits?

Co-op students have looked into timing of GEM data in simulation.

- Sophie looked at how the ADC value of the “peak” channel of the cluster changes over time samples
- Andy looked at using the GEM as a time-projection chamber to reconstruct track angles

Credit: Sophie Gelinas

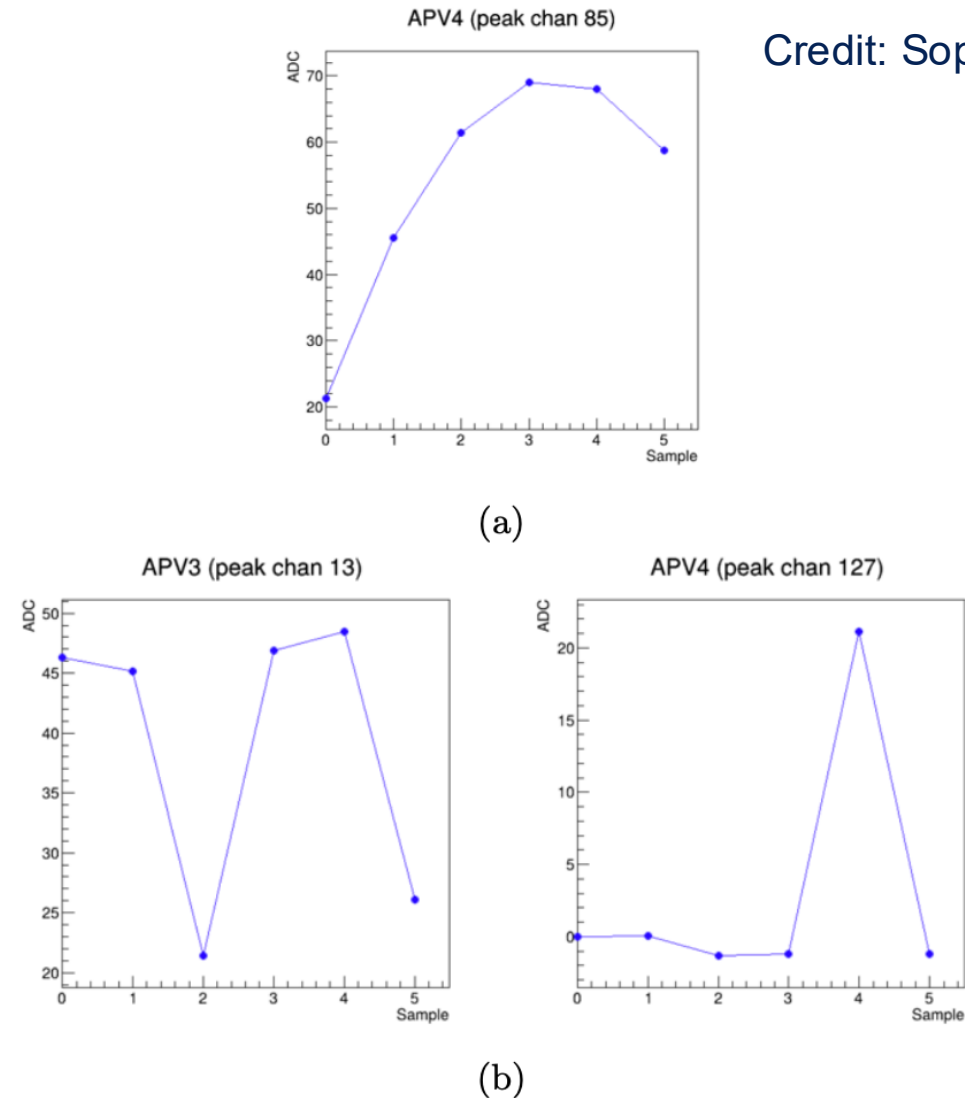


Figure 5: ADC of peak channel vs. sample number for a single APV. (a) shows an x-axis APV, and (b) shows two y-axis APVs.

## 1. “Max Charge Time”

- Charge  $\equiv$  sum of ADC values in all channels in cluster
- How this is calculated:
  - Calculate charge of each sample
  - Calculate “Max Charge Time” as mean sample time weighted by charge of each sample

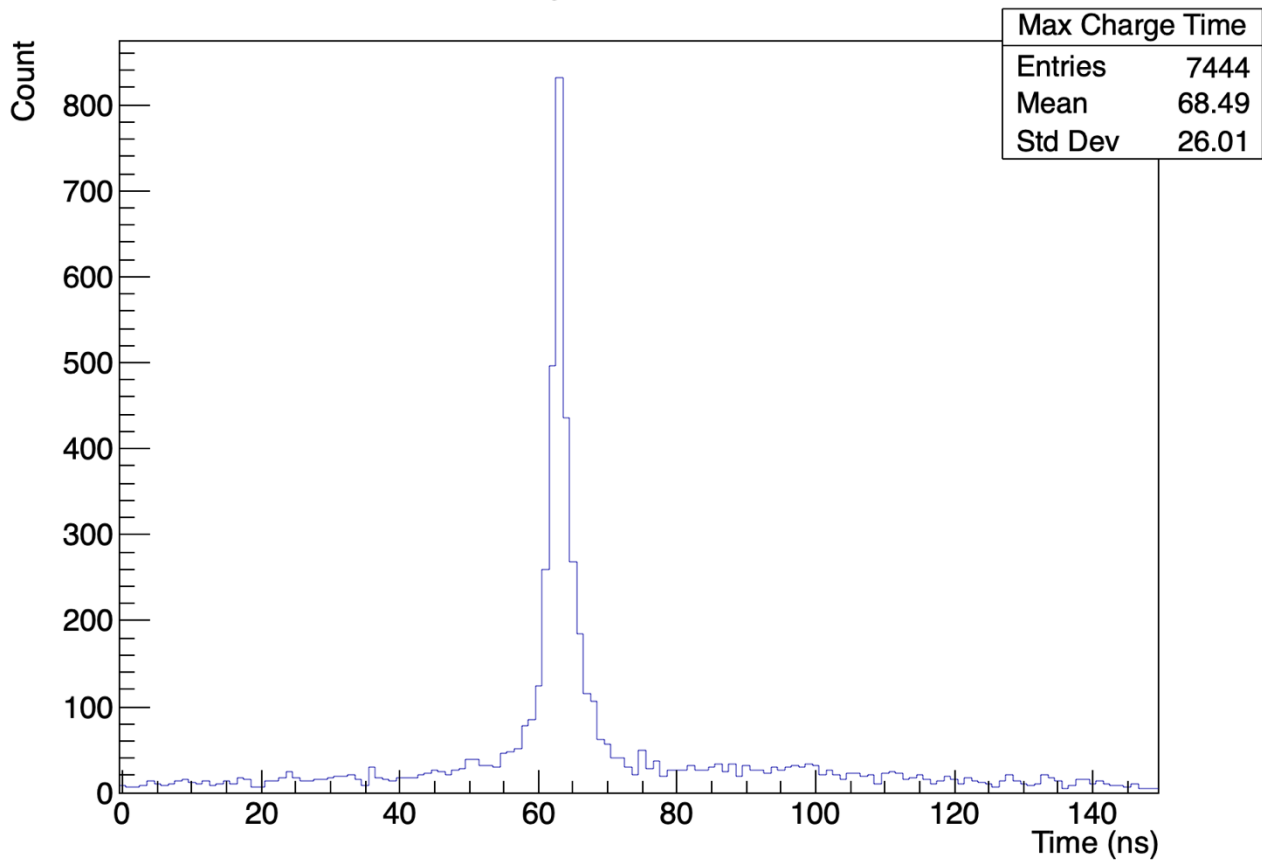
## 2. “Max ADC Time”

- How this is calculated:
  - Find maximum ADC value in each time sample
  - Calculate “Max ADC Time” as mean sample time weighted by maximum ADC value in each sample

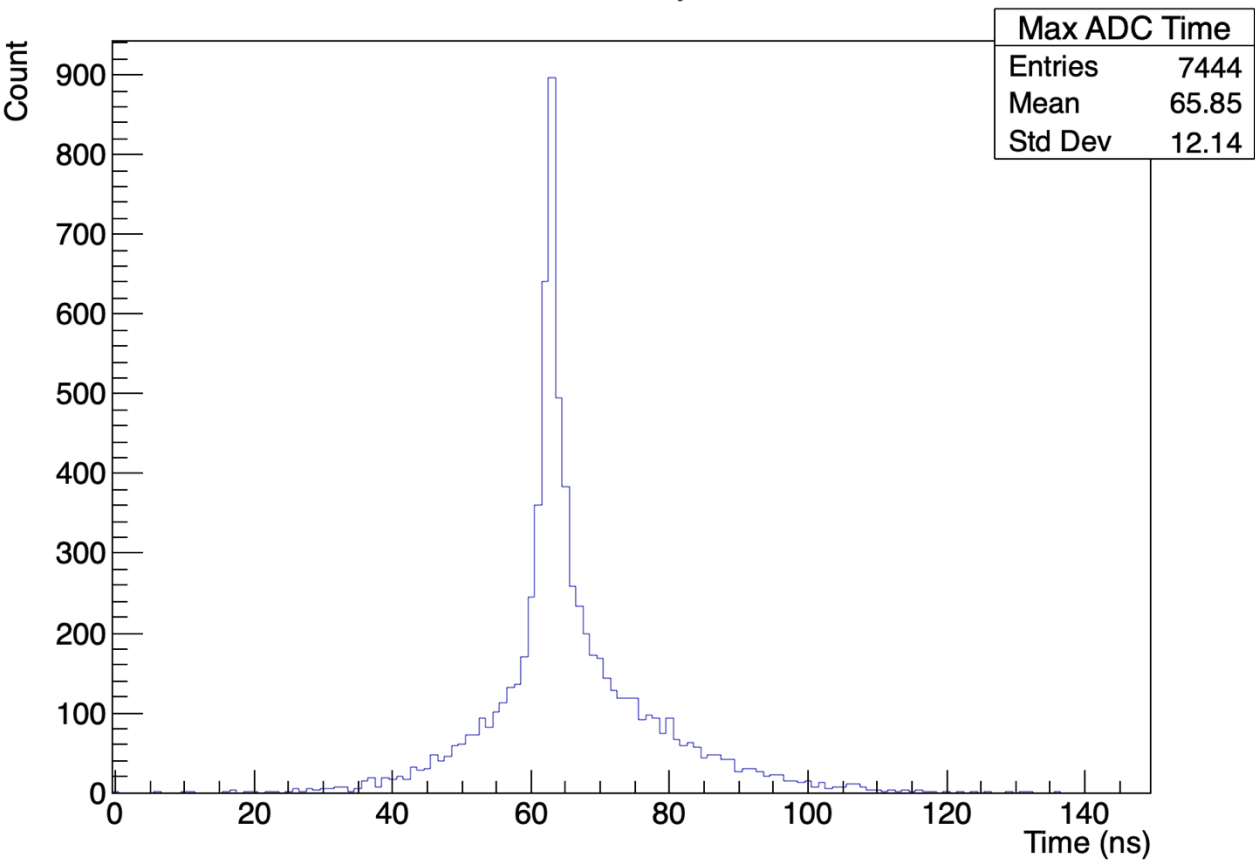
## Left Top GEM – X axis cluster times

Run 2679  
Cosmic  
Full Readout  
100k Events

Max Charge Time per Cluster



Max ADC Time per Cluster



- Investigate correlation between first-order cluster time and trigger times in good cosmic ray tracks
- Implement fitting function to improve measure of cluster time

```
242     if (false)
243     { // Previous Method
244
245         input_data data;
246         int index = 0;
247         for (int j = pos - 4; j <= pos + 4; j++)
248         {
249             data.x[index] = j - pos;
250             data.y[index] = values[j];
251             index++;
252         }
253
254         const u_int m = 9, n_par = 3; // Initializing a ton of cminpack stuff
255         int maxfev, mode, nprint, info, nfev, ldfjac, ipvt[n_par];
256         double ftol, xtol, gtol, epsfcn, factor, fnorm, par[n_par], diag[n_par], qtf[
257
258         std::unique_ptr<double[]> fjac = std::make_unique<double[]>(m * n_par);
259         std::unique_ptr<double[]> fvec = std::make_unique<double[]>(m);
260         std::unique_ptr<double[]> wa4 = std::make_unique<double[]>(m);
261
262         par[0] = values[(int)pos];
263         par[1] = 0;
264         par[2] = 0.7;
265
```

**Gaussian fitting method**



- Instead, the code decides if something is a cluster if its amplitude passes a threshold

```
401     double sig;  
402     double med;  
403     GetMedianAndFilteredStd(pereventhisto, sig, med, 1.0);  
404  
405     if (max - min > 5 * sig)  
406     {  
407         // std::cout << "max: " << max << " min: " << min << " sig: " << sig <<  
408         // std::cout << "max-min" << max-min << " 5*sig: " << 5*sig << std::end  
409
```

- If anyone has information about this code, please let me know



After workfest, my code compiles but crashes when running GEMtrack

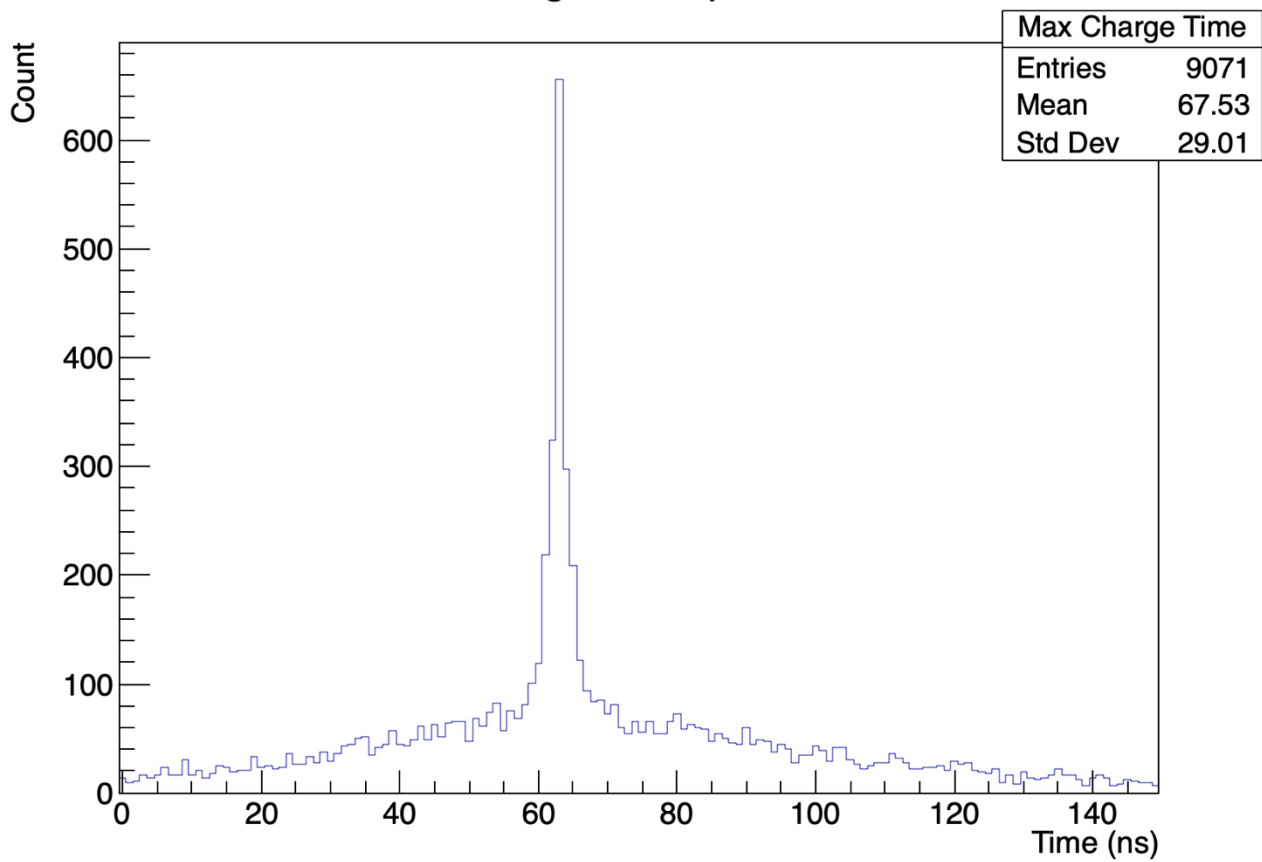
- Missing library files
- “terminating due to uncaught exception of type std::bad\_alloc: std::bad\_alloc”



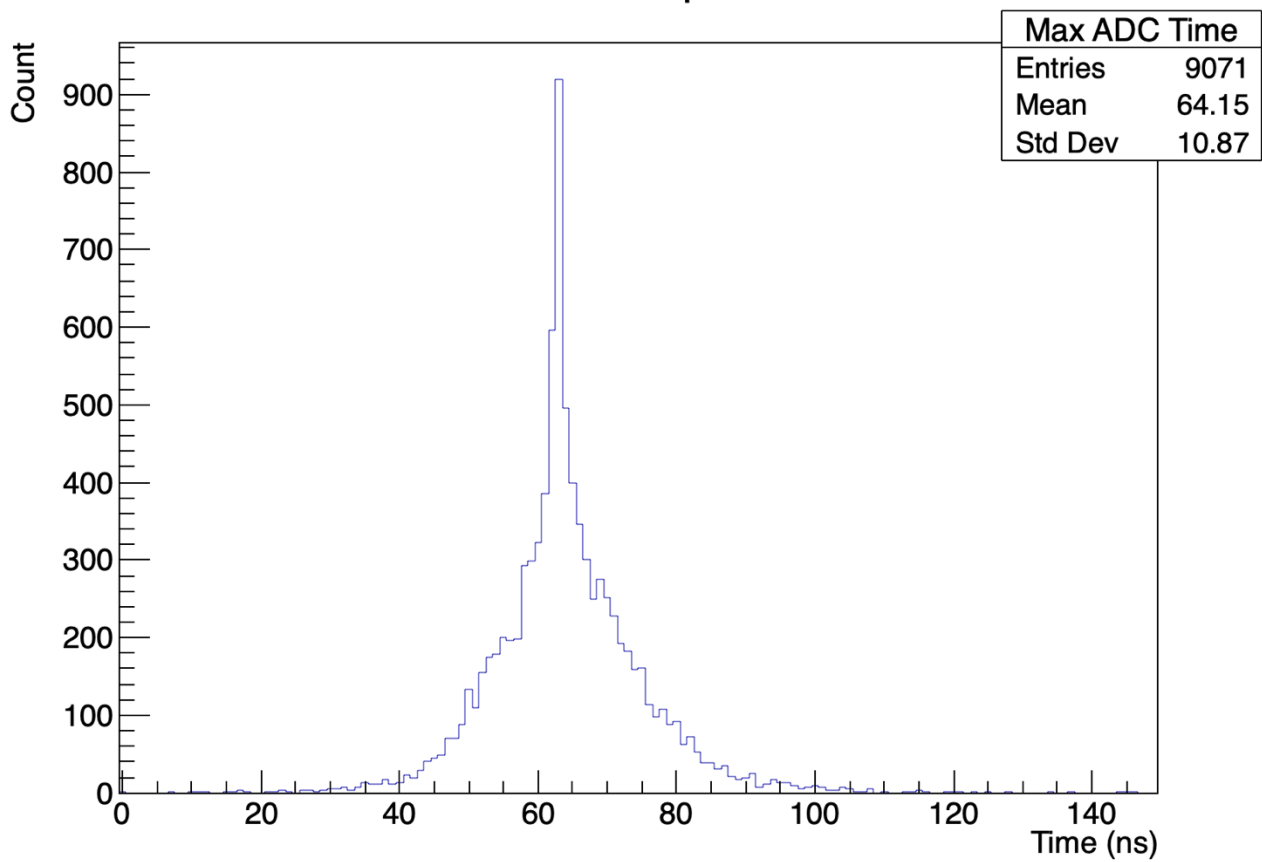
**Thank you**

Run 2679  
Cosmic  
Full Readout  
100k Events

Max Charge Time per Cluster

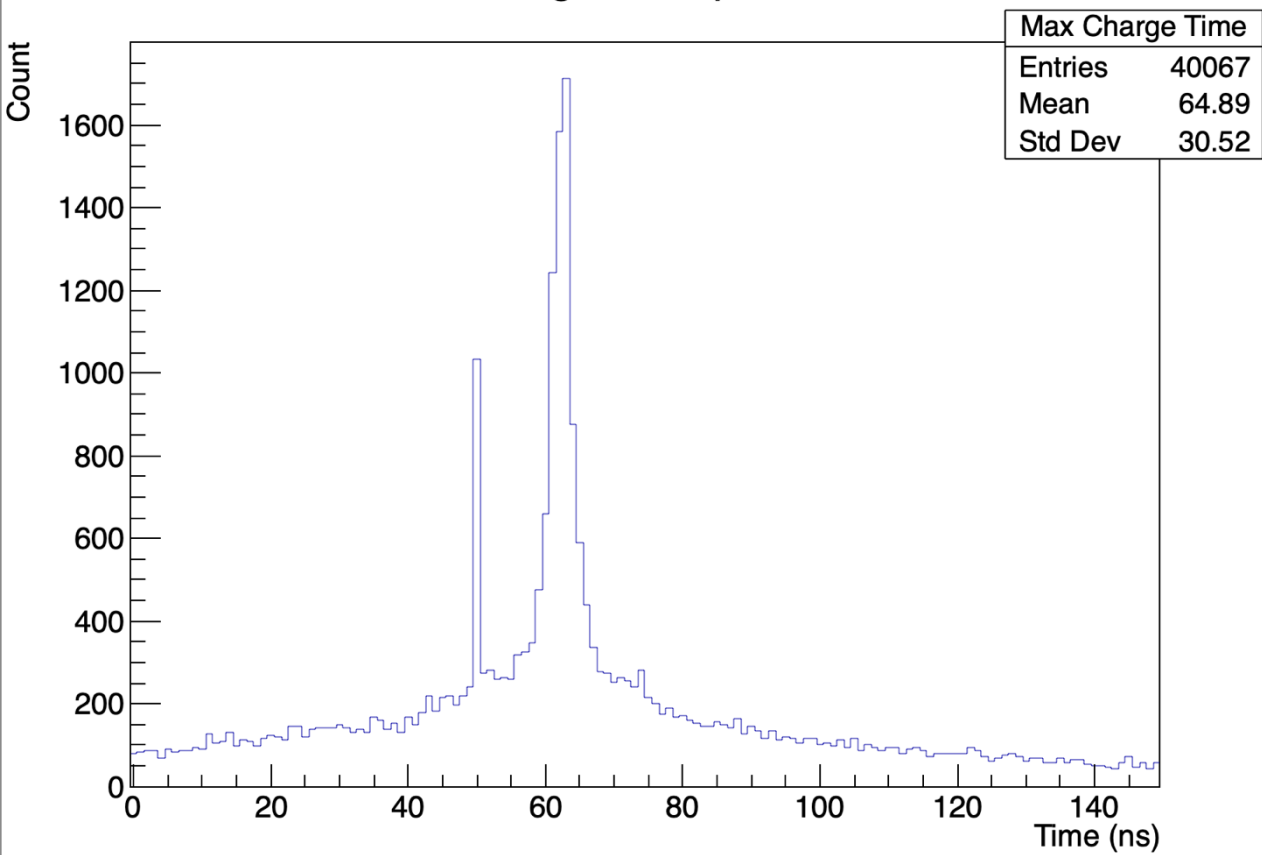


Max ADC Time per Cluster

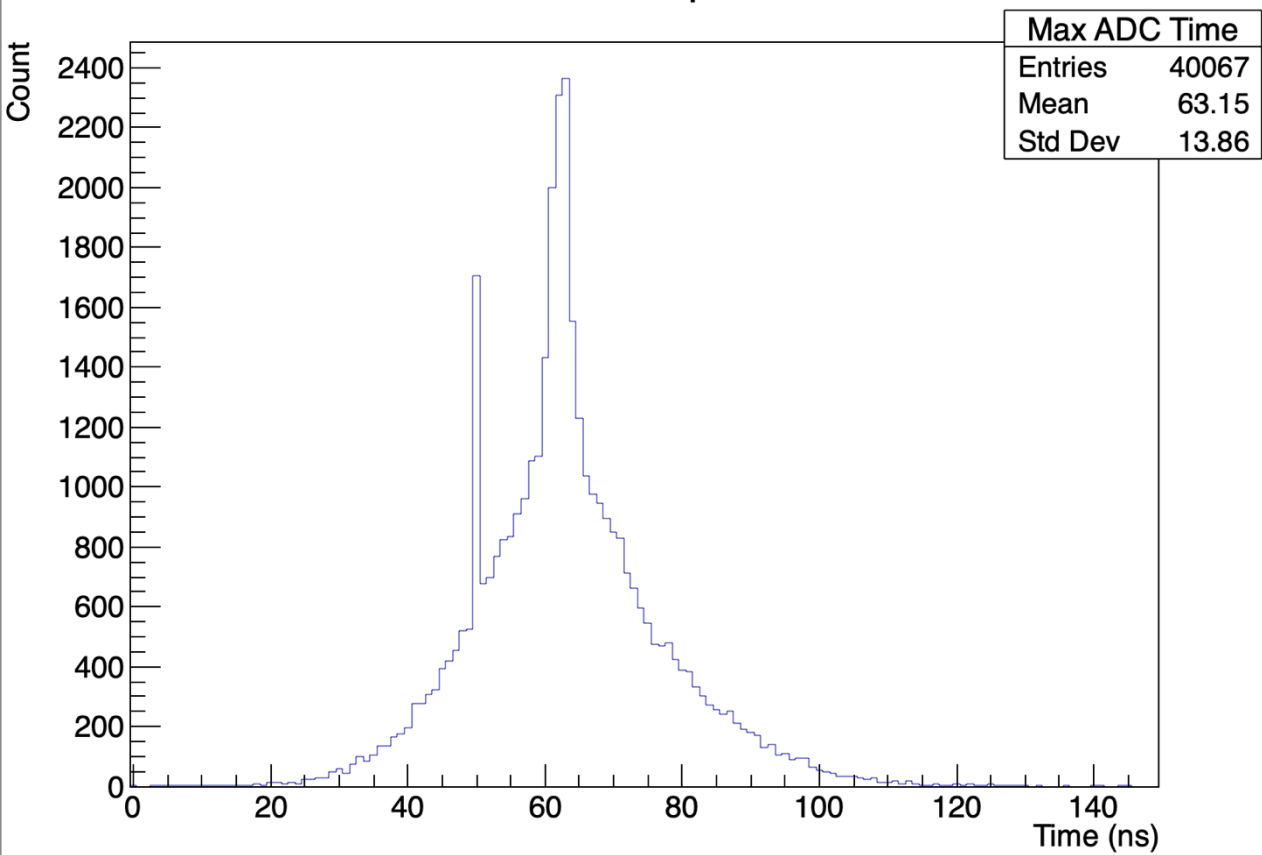


Run 2679  
Cosmic  
Full Readout  
100k Events

Max Charge Time per Cluster

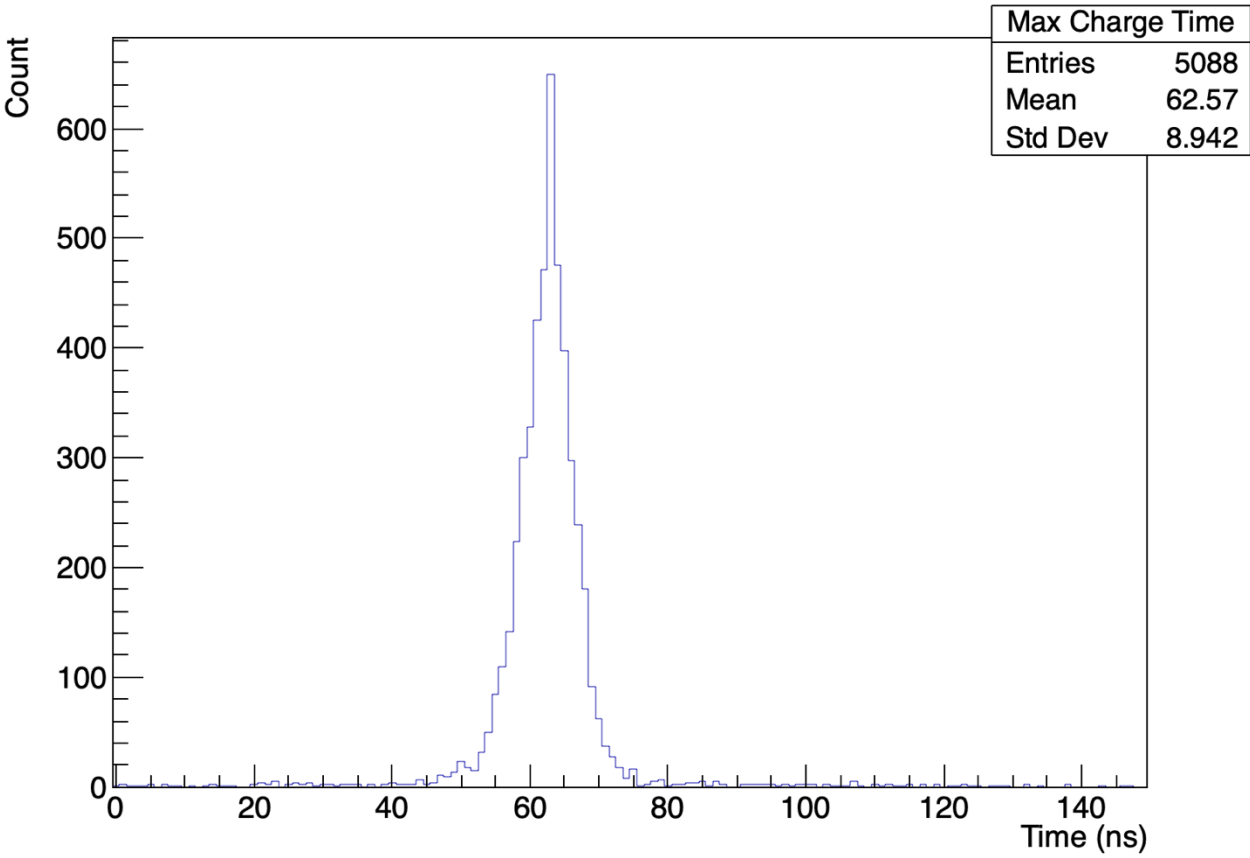


Max ADC Time per Cluster



Run 2679  
Cosmic  
Full Readout  
100k Events

Max Charge Time per Cluster



Max ADC Time per Cluster

